SEARCH EXPERIENCE AUDIT

AutoZone

A diagnostic of your search and discovery experience

2.6/10

SEARCH SCORE

NEEDS SIGNIFICANT WORK

5	5	13	~$36.9M/yr [ESTIMATE — 10% moderate lift scenario]
CRITICAL GAPS	MODERATE GAPS	TOTAL FINDINGS	EST. SEARCH ROI

ACT I — THE VERDICT

What We Found

We ran 13 search tests across AutoZone's site on 2026-03-18. Here is what your customers experience today.

2.6
/10
SEARCH SCORE

Latency	7.0
Typo Tolerance	2.0
Query Suggestions	2.0
Empty State	
Intent Detection	4.0
Merchandising	5.0
Consistency	
Content	2.0
Commerce Ux	
Semantic Nlp	2.0
Search	
Dynamic Facets	4.0
Personalization	
Recommendations	1.0
Merchandising	
Search Intelligence	3.0

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CRITICAL

Typo Tolerance Failure

When a customer types 'brak pads' instead of 'brake pads', the search fails — no autocorrect, no helpful prompt, no forgiving results. The customer bounces. Google already corrects 'autzone' to 'AutoZone' (33K monthly clicks) — your on-site search should too.

Algolia solution: Algolia built-in typo tolerance handles 1–2 character errors natively, no configuration required. Typo-corrected results are returned in under 50ms with an optional 'Did you mean' prompt. Case study →

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CRITICAL

No Query Suggestions / Empty State Gap

18.9% of AutoZone's organic traffic lands on the homepage and immediately searches. An empty search box with no suggestions forces customers to know exactly what to type — missing the discovery opportunity for browsing customers.

ACT II — THE OPPORTUNITY

What Fixing Search Unlocks

Search-driven revenue recovery is one of the fastest-payback investments in digital commerce.

Your Revenue at Stake

Based on industry benchmarks: 15% of digital revenue flows through search. A 5% conversion lift from improved search is conservative. [Yahoo Finance — FY2025 Annual]

Source: Yahoo Finance — FY2025 Annual

Recommended Next Steps

1
Connect with Jamey Maki (VP eCommerce)
Send a 3-bullet personalized LinkedIn message: headlamp 23x gap, Duralast 2-result brand failure, ChatGPT NLP gap. No deck, no pricing. Reference the Q2 FY2026 catalog expansion quote as urgency context.
2
Technical Demo — AutoZone-Specific Queries
Demo framed around the 5 Phase 2 gaps: headlamp/headlight synonyms, Duralast brand intent, NLP query on 2019 Camry oil, federated 'return policy' search, and empty-state query suggestions. Show Algolia on AutoZone's actual query patterns.
3
CIO Architecture Meeting with Michelle Borninkhof
Architecture overview: API-first headless integration with existing React/Next.js/Contentstack stack. Reference McDonald's/Walmart Algolia-scale familiarity. Supply Chain 2030 completion as the transition hook.
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